analyses of the world from the Sanatana perspective. Tragically, the effort was halted in 1947.

What Christopher Columbus failed but Vasco da Gama succeeded in—discovering India—are underscored by the same motive. In retrospect, Vasco da Gama was the feeble forerunner of a more far-reaching and eminently successful project of colonising the indigenous psyche. Indeed, a measure of the sorry depth of our mental colonisation is visible even in recent history. In 1998, the Kerala government decided to celebrate the 500th 'anniversary' of Vasco da Gama's 'arrival' in India as though he was a benefactor of sorts. However, this only shows the comprehensive extent of the success of the European colonial project.

Sri Sai Deepak's book is a detailed and multipronged exploration of precisely this phenomenon from the Sanatana standpoint. His book employs the approach derived largely from recent scholarship in the emerging discipline of decoloniality that originated in Latin America. Quite ambitious in its scope and candid in its tenor, the book is essentially a continuation of the ideas that were seeded by the luminaries of the modern Indian Renaissance but uses contemporary academic epistemologies.

What is also notable is Sri Sai Deepak's frank declaration that he has adopted a 'learner's approach', a rare honesty of taking a firm position that is difficult to find in what is today known as mainstream academic scholarship. The wealth of evidence the author marshals in support of his arguments is truly impressive and reflects the rigour of his study. I have no doubt that *India that is Bharat* will be a welcome addition to the nascent corpus of literature in this specialist field. That it has emerged from India is a bonus. I wish the book and its author all the success in getting the recognition it deserves.

—Sandeep Balakrishna
Scholar and Author of Invaders and Infidels

The book is a must-read for everyone who is interested in understanding the relationship between the consciousness of the world's oldest surviving indigenous civilisation and the Constitution of the world's largest democracy.

—Professor Lavanya Vemsani
Professor of History, Shawnee State University,
and Editor-in-Chief, *American Journal of Indic Studies*